Adam Hickey

Senior Product Designer · Visual Design · Design Systems · Service Design · Prototyping in Code

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Professional summary

Building is getting easier. Knowing what matters isn't. Senior product designer with 20 years across visual design, interactive experiences, and enterprise software, for organizations including Cargill, Intel, CBRE, and Toro. I began as a hybrid designer and developer, building what I designed in HTML, CSS, and jQuery, then spent thirteen years leading enterprise product design and design systems at scale. Now I bring those together early in a product: finding the right problem, making it tangible with service maps and working prototypes, and helping a team decide what to build.

Experience

Selected Independent Work — Product design, visual systems, prototyping 2026 – Present

- **Agent Review** — Designed and built, with Claude Code, a React and TypeScript prototype where agents build the screens and a designer decides what ships: written design rules and automated visual and accessibility checks, following one feature from ticket to release, on simulated runs.
- **The Shortlist** — A service design concept carrying one shopping trip from a phone into a store: a service map joining the journey and the blueprint, and a working prototype on sample data.
- **Door County Found** and **Lucy Learns** — two products in use, designed and built end to end: an editorial travel guide (identity, art direction, a site its editor keeps current) and an illustrated, offline-first dog-training app.

RBA Inc — Lead UX Product Designer 2013 – 2026

- Led UX and visual design for complex digital products, enterprise applications and design systems for clients in logistics, manufacturing, healthcare, financial services and the public sector, including compliance-sensitive work for a federal agency, a regional bank and healthcare providers.
- Sat with people through their workday and fixed what slowed them: usability testing on real tasks, information architecture, interaction design and visual hierarchy across large sets of screens, with developers in the room from the first sketch.
- Built and governed design systems across SAP, Microsoft, Umbraco, and Sitecore platforms: tokens, component libraries, contribution rules and release checkpoints, including one standard for 40+ SAP apps; designed and built Connect, the firm's own design-system site. Led the accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA), DesignOps and governance practices.
- Tied design to the numbers product, engineering, and business teams track: efficiency, adoption, quality, ROI.

Pixel Farm — Interactive Designer / Developer Jan 2008 – Apr 2013

Designed and built brand-led websites, campaigns and interactive pieces for Lund Boats, Fulton Beer, Hazelden and others, including Lund's boat configurator; shipped two native iOS apps and an iPad app; led rebrands and identity systems. Front ends in HTML, CSS and jQuery.

LEVEL — Interactive Designer Jan 2006 – Jan 2008

Designed and built websites and interactive pieces in HTML, CSS and Flash, beside writers, creative leads and developers.

ByDesign — Design Intern 2004 – 2006

Selected projects

- Making 40+ SAP applications feel like one product: one visual language, one design system and one accessibility standard, about a third less time from design to development, and UI defects in production cut roughly in half.
- An identity, illustration and badge system, templates and a community platform for a global corporation's innovation network, over four fiscal years; campaign production time roughly halved.
- Replacing spreadsheets with one USDA grant-management portal, cutting data-analysis requests from 45–55 hours to just over 10.
- A real-time cockpit for a 450+ truck fleet, built for the speed of expert dispatchers; board-clearing time down roughly 30%.

Core capabilities

UX & Interface Design · Visual Design & Typography · Complex Workflows · Information Architecture · Interaction Design · Design Systems & Governance · Accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA) · Brand Identity & Illustration · Prototyping in Code · Usability Testing · Human–AI Interaction · Service Design

Tools & platforms

Design: Figma/FigJam (variables, Dev Mode, component libraries) · Adobe Creative Cloud (Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign) · CSS custom properties (tokens) · ChatGPT & Gemini
Front end, by hand (2005–2013) and with coding agents now: HTML · CSS · JavaScript/jQuery · React · TypeScript · Storybook · Playwright · Vitest & axe · Git/GitHub · Claude Code (skills, plugins, MCP)
Platforms: SAP Fiori · Sitecore · Umbraco · WordPress · Joomla! · WCAG 2.1 AA

Education

Bachelor of Science in Graphic Design, University of Minnesota–Twin Cities (2005)